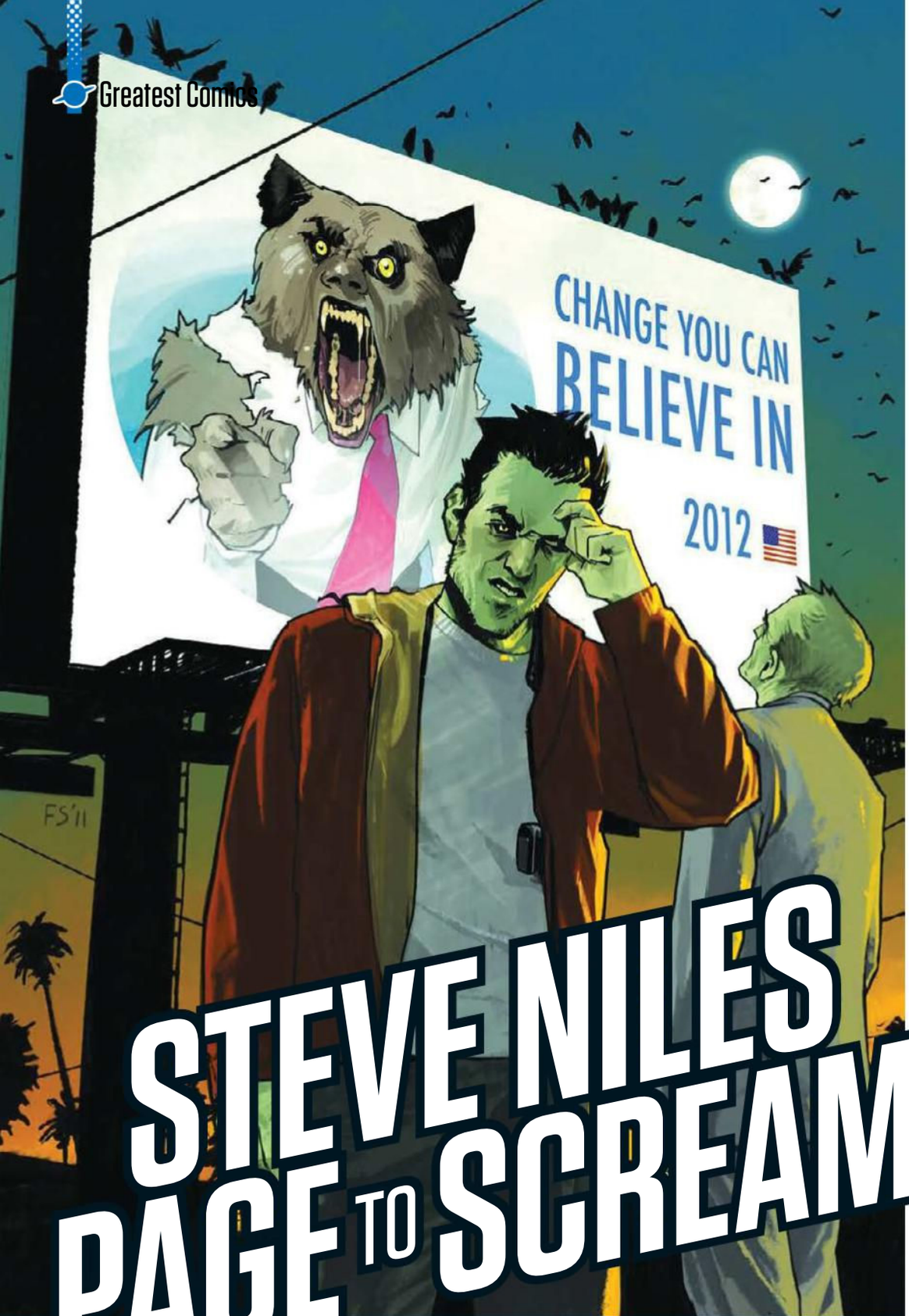
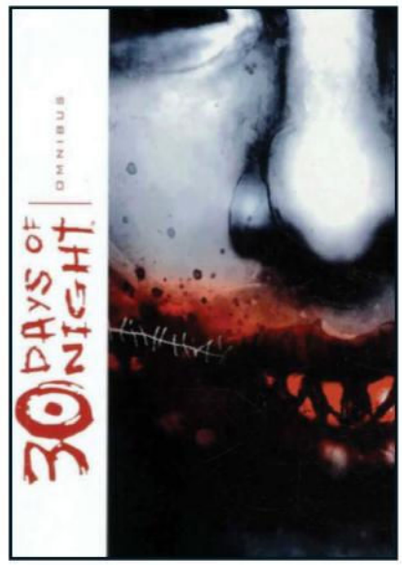


STEVE NILES PAGE TO SCREAM



WITH 30 DAYS OF NIGHT, STEVE NILES HELPED PIONEER THE BLOODY REBIRTH OF HORROR COMIC-BOOKS, AND NOW FINDS HOLLYWOOD CLAMOURING TO ADAPT HIS WORK. WE CHAT TO THE WRITER ABOUT CLASSIC HORROR AND FUTURE PLANS

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Having created series like *30 Days Of Night* and *Criminal Macabre* during his 20+ years in comics, Steve Niles is up there with *The Walking Dead* creator Robert Kirkman, *Locke & Key*'s Joe Hill and *American Vampire*'s Scott Snyder in the ranks of significant graphic horror writers. His uncompromising portrayal of vampires as an animalistic, viral force in *30 Days Of Night* preceded today's obsession with bloodsuckers, and everything the writer has fashioned in the meantime demonstrates his trend foresight.

Yet when it comes to his work being adapted for the big screen, Niles seeks out collaborators who share his enthusiasm – not necessarily the highest bidder. With the 2007 adaptation of the *30 Days Of Night* miniseries, his criteria was for talent that shared his passion for the subject matter. "Enthusiasm for the material means more to me than a big option," Niles tells us. "A good example is what happened with *30 Days Of Night*. When we were selling it, it turned into a bidding war with three studios bidding, and they all had a lot of money, but I went with the one that had Sam Raimi attached to it, because Sam knows horror."

Of course, *30 Days* remains the biggest Hollywood project based on Niles' work to date, but he has plenty more in the pipeline, ready to find a wider audience. Recently, his well-received post-apocalyptic zombie story *Remains* was adapted for a TV movie on the Chiller channel in America. The prospect of seeing one of his own projects adapted as a made-for-TV movie was hugely exciting for Niles, who grew up watching such films, and cites the work of Dan Curtis as an influence on his own career. "He was behind *The Night Stalker* and *Dark Shadows*, and was behind all these great TV movies. Richard Matheson also used to write a ton of ABC movies of the week during the Seventies, which are pretty much exactly this kind of stuff. They were Richard Matheson short stories turned into movies for TV, so I have a special affection for them.